

AI TOOLS THAT WORK

Write the Hard Message

Three real examples: a refund, a card dispute and a broken toaster. Where the AI went wrong, and the fix.

Tested October 4, 2026. Not legal advice.

Why this guide

Some messages are hard to start: a cancelled flight and a voucher you do not want, a card charge for something that never came, a toaster that died after a few months.

I did not ask the AI what the law is. I copied the rule from an official page, pasted it in, and asked for a short draft. Then I checked the draft against the page.

The situations are made up, and nobody sent any of these messages. The rules and the AI answers are real.

How I tested

I used a free public chat demo, with no account and no payment: the Qwen3 demo on Hugging Face

(huggingface.co/spaces/Qwen/Qwen3-Demo), model shown as Qwen3-235B-A22B.

I checked the rules on October 3, 2026 and ran the chats on October 4, 2026 (Saudi time). That was four runs: one per example, plus one follow-up fix for the second. One run each, so another run can answer differently.

Only public rules went in. The answers are shown word for word. I only changed curly quotes to straight quotes. I read each official page myself and compared every sentence of every answer with it.

Keep it private. This is a public demo. Do not paste account numbers, booking codes, receipts with your name, or addresses.

EXAMPLE 1

The cancelled flight

The airline cancelled your domestic flight and offered a voucher. You want the money back. The Department of Transportation has a refund page.

What DOT says (checked October 3, 2026)

- If an airline cancels a flight, for any reason, and you choose not to travel or accept credits or vouchers, you are entitled to a refund of the ticket price.
- A significant change includes a departure or arrival 3 hours or more different on a domestic trip.
- Bought directly from the airline? You are entitled to an automatic refund if you do not accept the alternative. For credit card purchases it must come within 7 business days.
- Airlines may offer credits or vouchers. You do not have to accept them.

Source: [transportation.gov/individuals/aviation-consumer-protection/refunds](https://www.transportation.gov/individuals/aviation-consumer-protection/refunds)

I pasted those points into the chat, added the situation, and asked for a short email with placeholders for anything I did not give.

What the AI wrote

ANSWER, 10.8 SECONDS

Subject: Refund Request for Cancelled Flight
[FLIGHT DETAILS]

Dear [Airline Name],

My flight [FLIGHT DETAILS] was cancelled, and I declined the offered voucher. As per US DOT regulations, I am entitled to a refund to my original credit card since I booked directly with the airline. Please process this refund within 7 business days.

Booking Code: [BOOKING CODE]

Thank you for your prompt assistance.

Sincerely,
Sam

[Not provided: [Airline Name], [FLIGHT DETAILS],
[BOOKING CODE]]

What it got right

- It used only the facts given, with placeholders for the rest.
- It kept the 7 business days and the credit card, both from the page.
- It stayed short and polite.

What needed fixing

- The email says the voucher was declined. The rule needs you to choose not to travel. The email never says that. Add one line.
- "Please process this refund within 7 business days" sounds like a deadline. The page says the airline must act within 7 business days of knowing you do not accept the alternative. Say "I do not accept the voucher or a rebooking".
- Its "not provided" list only repeats the placeholders. It does not mention the cancellation date.

EXAMPLE 2

The charge that never arrived

A charge on your card is for something that never came. You already phoned the card company. Now you need the written notice. The CFPB has a page on this.

What CFPB says (checked October 3, 2026)

- Call the card company right away.
- To protect your rights, also send a written billing error notice within 60 calendar days after the charge appeared on your statement.
- The company then has 30 days to send a letter confirming it received the dispute, unless it has finished its required procedures within that time.
- Keep copies and note the dates of follow-up calls.
- If you already paid the charge, you can still dispute it.

Source: consumerfinance.gov/ask-cfpb/how-do-i-dispute-a-charge-on-my-credit-card-bill-en-61/

Same method: I pasted the rule, added the situation, and asked for a short letter with

placeholders.

What the AI wrote

FIRST ANSWER, 14.1 SECONDS

[DATE]

Sam Smith

123 Main Street

City, State ZIP

Customer Service Department

Credit Card Company

456 Billing Lane

City, State ZIP

Re: Billing Error Dispute for Account #[ACCOUNT
NUMBER]

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to formally dispute a charge of [AMOUNT] from [MERCHANT] on my statement dated [DATE]. This charge violates 16 CFR § 1025.9 (billing error notice) as the referenced item was never delivered. I previously contacted your company by phone on [DATE] to report this issue.

Under CFPB guidelines, I submit this written notice within 60 days of the charge appearing on my statement. Please investigate and resolve this dispute within 30 days of receiving this letter, as required by law. A copy of my payment confirmation

is attached.

Keep copies of all correspondence and respond in writing. Contact me at sam@example.com or (555) 123-4567 for updates.

Sincerely,
Sam Smith

Not provided: Specific charge date, amount, merchant name, account number.

This one went wrong

What needed fixing

- It cited "16 CFR 1025.9". I never gave it that. Do not put a law number in a letter because an AI wrote it.
- It invented a name (Sam Smith), a street address, an email and a phone number. Placeholders were requested.
- It said "A copy of my payment confirmation is attached". Nothing is attached and I never said I paid.
- It said the company must "resolve this dispute within 30 days". The page says 30 days to confirm it received the dispute.

The repair. In the same chat I replied with four plain rules: no law numbers, no invented contact details, nothing attached, and 30 days is for confirming receipt.

The second try

REPLY, 14.2 SECONDS

Re: Billing Error Dispute for Account #[ACCOUNT NUMBER]

Dear Customer Service,

I am writing to formally dispute a charge of [AMOUNT] from [MERCHANT] on my statement dated [DATE]. This charge qualifies as a billing error because the item was never delivered. I already contacted your company by phone on [DATE] to report this issue.

Per the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau's billing error notice guidelines, I am submitting this written dispute within 60 days of the charge appearing on my statement. Please acknowledge receipt of this dispute in writing within 30 days, as required.

Even though I paid the charge, I reserve my right to dispute it. Please investigate and respond in writing. Contact me at [YOUR PHONE] or [YOUR EMAIL] for updates.

Sincerely,
[YOUR NAME]

Not provided: Specific charge date, amount, merchant name, account number, email, phone number.

What it got right

- No law number, invented name or attachment.
- It says to acknowledge receipt within 30 days, matching the page.

What needed fixing

- "Even though I paid the charge" is new. I never said I paid. Delete it.
- Check your own card agreement. The page tells you to read it.

EXAMPLE 3

The toaster that quit

Your toaster stopped working after a few months. You have the receipt and never read the warranty card. The FTC has a page on warranties.

What the FTC says (checked October 3, 2026)

- A written warranty may say what the company will do if the product fails: repair, replace or refund.
- Keep the warranty and the receipt. The receipt proves the purchase date.
- Laws in every state create implied warranties that cover almost everything you buy, including that a product will do what it is supposed to do.
- Implied warranties apply unless the seller gave written notice of no warranty or marked the product "as is", if state law allows that.
- How long they last depends on the state.

Source: consumer.ftc.gov/articles/warranties

I told the AI that the warranty card was unread. I did not say the email should mention it.

What the AI wrote

ANSWER, 6.2 SECONDS

Subject: Request for Warranty Support for [PRODUCT]

Dear [Company Name],

My [PRODUCT] stopped working after several months of use. I purchased it on [PURCHASE DATE] (order #[ORDER NUMBER]) and have the receipt. Though I did not review the warranty card, FTC guidelines state that implied warranties of merchantability apply to purchases unless explicitly disclaimed. Per federal and state laws, I request a repair, replacement, or refund as remedies for the defect. Please advise next steps.

Thank you,
Sam

Not included: Warranty terms, exact purchase date, order number, state-specific implied warranty duration.

What it got right

- Short, calm, and it asks for repair, replacement or a refund, which matches the page.
- It left placeholders for the product, date and order number.

What needed fixing

- It told the company "I did not review the warranty card". That was background for the AI, not something to tell the seller. Delete it.
- "Per federal and state laws" is bigger than the page. The FTC says state laws create implied warranties. Say "implied warranty of merchantability" and leave out "federal".
- The page says how long implied warranties last depends on the state. The email does not ask the company to confirm its own warranty terms. Add a line asking for them.

What I took from this

The same three habits worked every time: paste the rule, say what not to invent, check the answer. When the AI broke the "do not invent" line, a short reply naming the exact problems fixed most of it. It still needed a human read.

Before you send a message an AI helped write:

1. Is every date, amount and name one you gave it?
2. Does every rule match the official page?
3. Delete any law number or quote you did not supply.
4. Remove anything personal you gave only as background.
5. Is the one thing you want stated clearly?

The prompts

Copy these and change the details to match your situation.

PROMPT 1: REFUND EMAIL

I need to write a short, polite email to an airline asking for a refund. Use only the facts below. Do not invent flight numbers, dates, prices or policies.

Rules (from the US Department of Transportation refund page, checked October 3, 2026):

- If an airline cancels a flight, for any reason, and the passenger chooses not to travel or accept travel credits or vouchers, the passenger is entitled to a refund of the ticket price.
- A significant change includes a departure or arrival 3 hours or more different on a domestic trip.
- If you bought directly from the airline, you are entitled to an automatic refund when you do not accept the alternative. For credit card purchases it must be provided within 7 business days.
- Airlines may offer travel credits or vouchers instead of a refund. You do not have to accept them.

My situation: Sam is a made-up traveler. The airline cancelled Sam's domestic flight. The airline offered a voucher. Sam does not want the voucher and wants the money back to the original credit card. Sam bought directly from the airline.

Write the email in under 120 words. Leave [FLIGHT DETAILS] and [BOOKING CODE] as placeholders. Plain text only, no tables. After the email, list in one line anything you were not told.

PROMPT 2: CARD DISPUTE LETTER

Help me write a short letter to a credit card company disputing a charge. Use only the facts below. Do not invent dates, amounts or account numbers.

Rules (from the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau page "How do I dispute a charge on my credit card bill?", checked October 3, 2026):

- Call the card company right away.
- To protect your rights, also send a written billing error notice within 60 calendar days after the charge appeared on your statement.
- After receiving the notice, the company has 30 days to send a letter confirming it received the dispute, unless it has finished its required procedures within that time.
- Keep copies of everything and write down the dates of follow-up calls.
- If you already paid the charge, you can still dispute it.

My situation: Sam is a made-up customer. A charge on Sam's statement is for an item that was never delivered. Sam already called the card company.

Write the letter in under 150 words. Leave [DATE], [AMOUNT], [MERCHANT] and [ACCOUNT NUMBER] as placeholders. Plain text only, no tables. After the letter, list in one line anything you were not told.

PROMPT 2, REPAIR REPLY

Your letter added things I did not give you. Please rewrite it with these fixes:

- Do not cite any law or regulation number. Say only "billing error notice".
- Do not invent a name, street address, email or phone number. Use [YOUR NAME], [YOUR ADDRESS] and [YOUR PHONE] as placeholders.
- Do not say anything is attached.
- The rule says the company has 30 days to confirm it received the dispute. It does not say the dispute is resolved in 30 days. Say it that way.

Plain text only, under 150 words.

PROMPT 3: WARRANTY EMAIL

Help me write a short email to a company about a product that stopped working. Use only the facts below. Do not invent dates, model names or policies.

Rules (from the US Federal Trade Commission page "Warranties", checked October 3, 2026):

- A written warranty may say what the company will do if the product fails: repair, replace or refund.
- Keep a copy of the warranty and the receipt. The receipt proves the purchase date.
- Laws in every state create implied warranties that cover almost everything you buy. A warranty of merchantability means the product will do what it is supposed to do.
- Implied warranties apply unless the seller gave written notice of no warranty or marked the product "as is", if state law allows that.
- How long they last depends on the state, so check with a state consumer protection office.

My situation: Sam is a made-up customer. Sam's toaster stopped working after a few months. Sam has the receipt. Sam did not read the warranty card.

Write the email in under 130 words. Leave [PRODUCT], [PURCHASE DATE] and [ORDER NUMBER] as placeholders. Plain text only, no tables. After the email, list in one line anything you were not told.

Limits and sources

- One public demo model, one day, one run per prompt. Another run or another tool can give a different answer.
- I did not test on a phone.
- The rules come from US government pages as checked on October 3, 2026. They can change. Your airline, card agreement or state may add rules.
- This guide is not legal advice. For a large amount or a dispute that is not going well, contact your state consumer protection office or a lawyer.
- The airline, the card and the toaster are made up. No message here was sent.

SOURCES

US Department of Transportation, Refunds: [transportation.gov/individuals/aviation-consumer-protection/refunds](https://www.transportation.gov/individuals/aviation-consumer-protection/refunds)

CFPB, How do I dispute a charge on my credit card bill?: consumerfinance.gov/ask-cfpb/how-do-i-dispute-a-charge-on-my-credit-card-bill-en-61/

FTC, Warranties: consumer.ftc.gov/articles/warranties

Qwen3 demo:

huggingface.co/spaces/Qwen/Qwen3-Demo

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